singularities are clothed; naked singularities are forbidden). But whether cosmic censorship is wrong or right, most physicists have accommodated to singularities and, like Wheeler, expect the ill-understood laws of quantum gravity to tame them—ruling and controlling them in just the same way as Newton's or Einstein's laws of gravity rule the planets and control their orbits around the Sun.

- Wormholes and time machines today are regarded as outrageous by most physicists, even though Einstein's general relativistic laws permit them to exist. Skeptical physicists can take comfort, however, in our newfound knowledge that the existence of wormholes and time machines is controlled not by Einstein's rather permissive laws, but rather by the more restrictive laws of quantum fields in curved spacetime, and quantum gravity. When we understand those laws better, *perhaps* they will teach us unequivocally that physical laws always protect the Universe against wormholes and time machines—or at least time machines. Perhaps.

What can we expect in the coming century, the second century of Einstein's legacy?

It seems likely that the revolution in our understanding of space, time, and objects built from spacetime warpage will be no less than in the first century. The seeds for revolution have been laid:

- Gravitational-wave detectors will soon bring us observational maps of black holes, and the symphonic sounds of black holes colliding—symphonies filled with rich, new information about how warped spacetime behaves when wildly vibrating. Supercomputer simulations will attempt to replicate the symphonies and tell us what they mean, and black holes thereby will become objects of detailed experimental scrutiny. What will that scrutiny teach us? There will be surprises.
- Ultimately, in the coming century, most likely sooner rather than later, some insightful physicist will discover and unveil the laws of quantum gravity, in all their intimate detail.
- With those quantum gravity laws in hand, we may figure out precisely how our Universe's spacetime came into being, how it